

You become like the people you're around

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/U6Y5SARocU0> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Your environment and social circle shape your habits automatically. Brandon Carter argues you absorb the behaviors of those around you — for better or worse — so you must deliberately curate who you spend time with.

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🏆 Social Influence Works Both Ways 0:00

- Carter observes that friends who start spending more time around him begin losing weight
 - His explanation: they unconsciously pick up on his habits — he doesn't get worse, they get better
 - His girlfriend is in better shape now than when they first got together, attributed to the same effect
- He frames this as a form of influence he calls "gymnasium Jesus" — the idea that proximity to someone with strong habits can be transformative

"When you're around gymnasium Jesus, you won't get healed" — meaning his fitness habits are so embedded that they rub off on everyone close to him.

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- Because influence flows both directions, Carter deliberately avoids people whose habits he doesn't want to adopt
 - His rule: if someone has habits he wouldn't want to involuntarily absorb, he keeps his distance
 - Example given: someone who cheats on their partner or engages in "foul" behavior — Carter stays away to prevent that negativity from infiltrating his own life
- The core takeaway is intentionality — curating your circle is not about judgment but self-protection and standards maintenance